

Day 5 — Mid-Project Critique

Module: Project Implementation · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will have given and received structured peer feedback on their project plan, sources, and first sketch — and will leave with a written list of at least three changes they'll make over Days 6–7.

Materials

- Each student brings: their plan, citation slips, and sketch
- Printed **Critique Protocol Sheet** (see template below), 2 per student
- Notebook / project journal
- Sticky notes

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily prompt: *“Yesterday’s pair-share comment from your partner — what did they say? Did you agree?”* — 3 students share.
- The reframe: *“Critique is a gift, not an attack. The right response is ‘thank you’ and a question. Not defence.”*

Core (10 min)

1. **Three critique rules** (3 min). Write on the board:
 - **Be kind.** The other person worked hard. Open with what you noticed and admired.
 - **Be specific.** “I like it” is useless. “The colour key on your mandala helps me see the elements without reading text” is useful.
 - **Be helpful.** Don’t just list problems — propose a fix.
2. **The protocol** (4 min). Pairs use this exact structure, ~15 minutes per direction (so each student presents once and listens once):
 1. **Presenter shares (3 min)** — walks through the plan, sources, sketch. No defending yet.
 2. **Critic asks clarifying questions (2 min)** — only questions, no judgement yet.
 3. **Critic gives “I notice / I wonder” (4 min)** — three “I notice...” observations, three “I wonder...” suggestions.
 4. **Presenter responds (3 min)** — what they’ll keep, what they’ll change, what they’ll think about overnight.
 5. **Switch.**

3. **Write down everything.** Both students' protocols are on paper. By end of class, every student has a written critique sheet to take home.

Activity (25 min) — Run the protocol

See `activities/activity-02-paired-critique.md` for the full activity and forms. Pairs are pre-assigned (teacher decides last night based on project-type variety — pair a herb-deck student with a sustainability-audit student, not two herb-deck students).

After both directions, the pair takes 3 minutes for a quick joint reflection: *“What’s one thing both our projects could use more of?”*

Wrap-up (5 min)

- **Pin the critique sheet** into the project journal — it’s part of the documentation evidence.
- Each student writes a three-item **change list** in the journal: > “Based on today’s critique I will: > 1. > 2. > 3. ____”
- Preview: *“Days 6 and 7 are quiet build sessions. I’ll be walking the room, not teaching. Bring all your materials tomorrow.”*

Student-facing content

Critique is a gift, not an attack.

Three rules: - **Be kind.** Open with what you noticed and admired. - **Be specific.** “I like it” is useless. “The colour key helps me see the elements without reading text” is useful. - **Be helpful.** Propose a fix, not just a problem.

The protocol: 1. Presenter shares (3 min). 2. Critic asks clarifying questions (2 min). 3. Critic gives “I notice / I wonder” (4 min) — three of each. 4. Presenter responds (3 min) — keep, change, think about.

Then switch.

Critique Protocol Sheet (template)

PROTOCOL SHEET – Mid-project critique

Presenter: _____ Critic: _____

PROJECT: _____

CLARIFYING QUESTIONS (critic notes here):

1. _____
2. _____

"I notice..." (3 specific observations):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

"I wonder..." (3 specific suggestions):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

PRESENTER'S RESPONSE:

- I'll keep: _____
- I'll change: _____
- I'll think about: _____

Homework

- Re-read your critic's notes overnight.
- Decide which three changes you'll make. Write them in your journal.
- Bring ALL materials to class tomorrow. Build session starts the moment you sit down.

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** After the protocol, write a 50-word paragraph in your journal about what changed in your *thinking*, not just your plan. Did the critique surface an assumption you didn't know you had?
- **One tier down:** If giving "three notices and three wonders" feels like too much, give two of each. Quality of one specific observation beats quantity.

Teacher notes

- This is a formative checkpoint disguised as an activity. By the end of today every student should be visibly ready to build. If not, that student gets a 10-minute one-on-one tomorrow before class.
- Listen at the doorway — you'll hear which pairs are doing the work and which are skating. Drop in on the skaters silently and ask one clarifying question.
- A critique that descends into mutual gushing is worthless. If you hear "your sketch is really nice" three times in a row, intervene and re-direct to specifics.
- After today, mark every student's plan + sources + sketch on the Day 5 formative quiz checklist (quizzes/formative.md Part A). This is your gate to allowing them into the build phase.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- No new scripture citation today; the term *vicāra* (inquiry, reflection) from Day 1 returns implicitly — critique is collective *vicāra*.